

ECCO - Recovered Requirements

As of 2026-10-02.

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Purpose, scope and method

ECCO must let people manage a family of product variants as one repository: commit variants with the features they provide, learn which artifacts implement which features, and compose new variants for feature combinations never committed as such. The name stands for *Extraction and Composition for Clone-and-Own*.

These requirements were recovered, not written up front. ECCO has no requirements specification; it has about 1,400 commits since January 2016, a [README](#), a [changelog](#) that stops at 0.1.9, and the research papers listed in the README. Each requirement below names where it was recovered from:

- **Doc** - stated in the README or a module README.
- **Code** - enforced by the implementation (a check, a refusal, a guard).
- **Test** - asserted by an automated test, the strongest evidence of intent.
- **History** - introduced or fixed by a specific commit; the fix shows what the system was expected to do.

Scope: the live Gradle modules (`base`, `service`, `logic`, `util`, `cli`, `gui`, `rest` and the adapters in `settings.gradle`). The retired storage backends, the `java6/java8/designspace` adapters and other unbuilt extras are out of scope.

shall = required and enforced; **should** = expected but not enforced everywhere.

Stakeholders and usage contexts

Stakeholder	Goal	Front end	Evidence
Variant developer (clone-and-own)	Keep developing individual variants while reusing features across them	CLI, GUI	README Use Cases; ICSME'14
Product-line engineer	Consolidate existing variants into a common platform; evolve features incrementally	GUI	SPLC'13, SoSyM'16, SST'15
Feature-location researcher	Compute feature-to-artifact traces from known variants; run benchmarks (SPLC challenge, VEVOS)	CLI, <code>experiment</code> , challenge adapter	SPLC'19
Distributed team	Exchange features, not whole histories, between repositories	CLI, GUI server	ICSE'16 doctoral symposium
Web-client user	Browse and operate repositories from a browser	REST + external ecco-client	<code>rest/README.md</code>

The use cases they bring:

1. **Feature location** - given variants with known configurations, compute which artifacts implement which feature.
2. **Extractive product-line engineering** - reverse-engineer a set of variants into a platform.
3. **Automated reuse for clone-and-own** - compose a new variant from features of existing ones.
4. **Reactive/incremental product-line engineering** - evolve variants and individual features over time.
5. **Feature-oriented distributed version control** - fork, pull and push with features as the unit of exchange.

Domain model

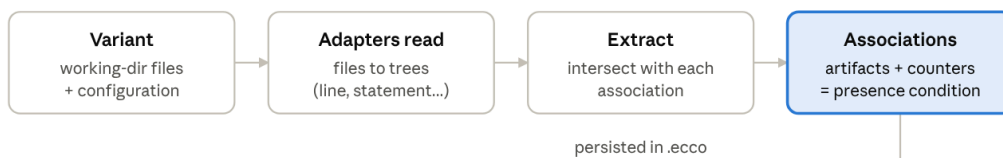
The names are the interfaces in `base` (package `at.jku.isse.ecco`).

Term	Meaning	Code
Feature	A named unit of functionality; identified by id, the name need not be unique	<code>feature.Feature</code>
Feature revision	One version of a feature; A ' creates a new one	<code>feature.FeatureRevision</code>
Configuration	The set of feature revisions a variant provides, e.g. <code>Base</code> , <code>Audio</code> , <code>Video.3f2a9c1</code>	<code>feature.Configuration</code>
Variant	A working directory's files together with its configuration; can be named and stored	<code>core.Variant</code>
Commit	One recorded variant: configuration, message, and the associations it touched	<code>core.Commit</code>
Artifact	One element of an artifact tree (file, line, statement, pixel...) with adapter-specific data	<code>artifact.Artifact</code> , <code>ArtifactData</code>
Node / artifact tree	The tree an adapter reads from files; nodes hold artifacts	<code>tree.Node</code> , <code>RootNode</code>
Association	A set of artifacts that always occurred together across commits	<code>core.Association</code>
Module / module revision	A feature interaction: positive and negative features (revisions) that co-occurred	<code>module.Module</code> , <code>ModuleRevision</code>
Counter	How often each module revision was seen with an association; the source of its condition	<code>counter.AssociationCounter</code>
Presence condition	Disjunction of module revisions; holds in a configuration when one of them holds	<code>module.Condition</code>
Partial order graph	The known orderings of sibling artifacts; ambiguous where commits disagree	<code>pog.PartialOrderGraph</code>
Feature trace	A presence condition stated up front (e.g. from VEVOS), not learned	<code>featuretrace.FeatureTrace</code>
Constraint	A mined or accepted relation between features (requires, excludes...)	<code>core.Constraint</code>
Remote	Another repository, by local path or <code>host:port</code>	<code>core.Remote</code>
Repository	All of the above, stored in a <code>.ecco</code> directory	<code>repository.Repository</code>

A commit never stores a variant whole: it splits the artifacts into associations, and a checkout reassembles any configuration whose associations' conditions hold.

Commit learns associations; checkout composes variants from them

COMMIT



CHECKOUT



Commit and checkout pipelines

Functional requirements

Paths are abbreviated: ES = `service/.../service/EccoService.java`, REPO = `base/.../repository/Repository.java`, DR/DW = `service/.../adapter/dispatch/DispatchReader.java/DispatchWriter.java`, STS = `service/.../storage/ser/dao/SerTransactionStrategy.java`.

Repository lifecycle

ID	Requirement	Source
FR-L1	<code>init</code> shall create <code>.ecco</code> and refuse if the service is already initialized or the directory exists; defaults come from <code>ecco.properties</code> (max order 2, PROACTIVE evaluation, BOOST main tree, <code>ser</code> storage).	Code ES:870-895
FR-L2	A failed <code>init</code> or <code>fork</code> shall remove the half-created repository so the operation can be retried.	Test <code>FailedForkCleanupTest</code>
FR-L3	<code>open</code> shall refuse a missing path, a non-directory or a directory without repository data, write nothing, and hint at a nested <code>.ecco</code> .	Test <code>OpenNonRepositoryTest</code> , <code>ForkFromWorkingDirectoryTest</code> ; History 6ee3496e
FR-L4	The service shall require exactly one storage plugin and at least one enabled artifact adapter.	Code ES:386-424
FR-L5	Every operation shall fail with “Service is not initialized” while no repository is open.	Code ES:375

Configurations

ID	Requirement	Source
FR-F1	A configuration shall be a comma-separated list of A (latest revision, or new feature), A' (new revision), A.<rev> (that revision) or [<id>] (feature by id); names are limited to [a-zA-Z0-9_-].	Doc; Code <code>Configuration.java:27</code> , <code>ConfigurationParser</code>
FR-F2	A revision id prefix of 7 or more characters shall resolve if unique.	Test <code>ShortRevisionIdTest</code> ; History 1294d248
FR-F3	An ambiguous feature name shall be rejected with a hint to use the feature id.	Code <code>ConfigurationParser:175</code>
FR-F4	Parsing a configuration shall not persist revisions as a side effect.	Test <code>ParseConfigurationPhantomRevisionTest</code>
FR-F5	A configuration shall hold at most one revision per feature.	Code REPO:509-516
FR-F6	[<id>] shall name an existing feature, with the same meaning as its name in every form; an unknown id is rejected.	Test <code>UnknownFeatureIdTest</code>

Commit

ID	Requirement	Source
FR-M1	A commit shall read the working directory through the adapters, extract its artifacts into associations, and update each association's counters (and so its presence condition).	Doc; Code <code>CommitService</code> , <code>Repository.extract</code>
FR-M2	A commit without any feature shall be refused.	Code <code>CommitService:55</code> ; History 26e445f1
FR-M3	Without an explicit configuration, a commit shall use <code><working dir>/config</code> , and fail if it exists but cannot be read.	Code <code>CommitService:118-128</code>
FR-M4	Each previously unseen configuration shall be recorded as a variant.	Code <code>CommitService:70-95</code>

ID	Requirement	Source
FR-M5	Files matching <code>.ecco/.ignores</code> (defaults <code>.DS_Store</code> , <code>.gitignore</code>) shall be skipped; <code>.ecco</code> , <code>.config</code> , <code>.warnings</code> and <code>.hashes</code> are always skipped.	Code DR:31-39; Test <code>DsStoreIgnoredRegressionTest</code> , <code>GitignoreIgnoredRegressionTest</code>
FR-M6	Files shall be routed by <code>.ecco/.adapters</code> (<code>pluginId;glob</code> , first match wins), written on first open from the adapters' priorities and fixed for the repository from then on.	Doc; Code DR:143-197
FR-M7	A file mapped to a disabled or missing adapter shall fail the commit, not fall back to another adapter; malformed <code>.adapters</code> lines are rejected.	Test <code>UnavailableAdapterRoutingTest</code>
FR-M8	An unreadable file shall fail the commit, not be committed empty; symlink loops are skipped.	Test <code>UnreadableFileCommitTest</code> , <code>SymlinkLoopCommitTest</code>
FR-M9	A commit or merge shall be refused into a repository holding artifacts in a retired adapter format; checkout still works.	Code REPO:1049-1090, <code>ArtifactData#retiredFormat</code>
FR-M10	A commit shall run in one read-write transaction and roll back on any error; a listener failure never rolls back a committed transaction.	Code <code>CommitService:62-110</code> , <code>ListenerRegistry:76-82</code>
FR-M11	Unchanged files should be recognized by the hashes in <code>.hashes</code> and not re-read. Deferred - see Known gaps #3.	Code DR:469-476

Checkout and composition

ID	Requirement	Source
FR-K1	A checkout shall select the associations whose presence condition holds for the configuration and prune the composed tree per node by the repository's evaluation strategy (RETROACTIVE, PROACTIVE, PROACTIVE-ADDITION, PROACTIVE-SUBTRACTION).	Code REPO:756-763, <code>CheckoutComposer</code> , <code>featuretrace/evaluation</code>
FR-K2	Sibling order shall come from the partial order graph; a graph with cycles, redundant transitive edges or wrong node counts is rejected.	Code <code>DefaultOrderSelector</code> , <code>PartialOrderGraph:347-358</code>
FR-K3	A checkout shall write into a working directory that is empty apart from <code>.ecco</code> , and refuse if <code>.config</code> , <code>.warnings</code> or <code>.hashes</code> exist.	Code DW:80-106, <code>CheckoutService:120-136</code>
FR-K4	A checkout shall write <code>.config</code> (the configuration) and <code>.warnings</code> .	Doc; Code <code>CheckoutService:139-167</code>
FR-K5	<code>.warnings</code> shall list, one per line with a suggested fix where one exists: MISSING feature interactions never committed, SURPLUS artifacts the configuration does not explain, ambiguous ORDER, UNRESOLVED associations, CONSTRAINT violations, and rejected TRACES.	Code <code>CheckoutService:139-167</code> ; Test <code>CheckoutMissingModuleDiagnosticsTest</code>
FR-K6	MISSING warnings shall be trimmed: an interaction is not reported when a smaller sub-combination of it is already missing.	Code <code>ModuleRevisions.java:38-58</code>
FR-K7	SURPLUS warnings shall be absorbed ($X + XY = X$) and suppressed when entailed by the accepted feature model; both on by default, a failure only logs, MISSING warnings are never suppressed.	Code <code>SurplusLatticeAbsorber</code> , <code>SurplusModuleSuppressor</code> ; History <code>ce32c243</code>
FR-K8	Constraint-violation warnings shall be advisory and never block a commit or checkout.	Code ES:1196-1207
FR-K9	Composition shall run in a read-only transaction.	Test <code>ReadWithoutTransactionTest</code>
FR-K10	Line-based files shall be written with the newest commit's encoding, line separator and final newline.	Test <code>TextFormatLastCommitWinsTest</code>

Constraints and condition minimization

ID	Requirement	Source
FR-N1	The system shall mine MANDATORY, REQUIRES and EXCLUDES constraints from committed configurations, with a minimum witness count (≥ 1 , default 4) and a confidence threshold (0-1, default 0.9; 1.0 = hard rules only), sorted hard first, then by witnesses.	Code <code>ConstraintMiner:80-210</code>
FR-N2	Mined constraints shall be suggestions only: never applied unless accepted.	Code <code>ConstraintMiner</code>
FR-N3	Constraints shall be mined per feature, so revisions of one feature are never mutually exclusive.	Code <code>ConfigurationBridge</code>
FR-N4	Accepted constraints shall be persisted and travel with fork, pull and push without duplication.	Test <code>ConstraintPersistenceMergeTest</code>
FR-N5	An accepted constraint shall only be trusted while re-mining still yields it.	Test <code>AcceptedConstraintStaleReMineTest</code>
FR-N6	Accepting or unaccepting many constraints shall be one transaction and one event.	Code <code>ConstraintService:84-122</code> ; History <code>d78d3cb0</code>
FR-N7	Presence-condition minimization shall drop a literal or term only when SAT-proven equivalent under the accepted feature model; it is a preview and does not change checkout.	Code <code>PresenceConditionMinimizer</code> ; Doc (<code>minimize-preview</code> is read-only)

Proactive feature traces

ID	Requirement	Source
FR-T1	The C, C++ and challenge adapters shall read VEVOS presence conditions (<code>pcs.variant.csv</code>) as proactive feature traces, using feature names that match the configuration's.	Code <code>VevosConditionHandler</code> ; History <code>c2135755</code>
FR-T2	A proactive trace shall hold in every commit containing its association and in no other; a contradicting trace is not used and is reported as a TRACE warning (too narrow / too broad) with the commit.	Code <code>ProactiveTraceCheck</code> ; History <code>cb7cf42e</code>

Distributed operations

ID	Requirement	Source
FR-D1	A remote shall be a local path (repository or its <code>.ecco</code>) or <code>host:port</code> (hostname, IPv4 or bracketed IPv6, port 1-65535); remote names are unique.	Test <code>RemoteAddressTest</code>
FR-D2	<code>fork</code> shall create a new repository from a remote into an empty location and register it as <code>origin</code> .	Code <code>ES:663-800</code>
FR-D3	<code>fetch</code> shall read a remote's features; <code>pull</code> and <code>push</code> shall merge a remote into this repository or this one into the remote.	Doc
FR-D4	<code>fork</code> , <code>pull</code> and <code>push</code> shall be able to exclude feature revisions: features left without revisions and modules containing excluded features are dropped, and an exclusion that leaves unresolved dependencies is refused.	Doc; Code <code>REPO:867-1033</code>
FR-D5	A fork or pull, reopened, shall check out the same content as the source.	History <code>f9cce6ba</code> , <code>8a4db407</code>
FR-D7	A fork shall not modify its origin repository.	Test <code>ForkLeavesOriginUnchangedTest</code>
FR-D6	The sync server shall refuse a second start, and accept only allow-listed classes when deserializing.	Test <code>RemoteSyncServerHardeningTest</code> ; Code <code>SyncObjectStreams</code>

Git import

ID	Requirement	Source
FR-G1	Git import shall read a local clone without touching its working tree or index, and apply commits oldest first along first parents.	Code <code>git/GitHistoryReader</code>
FR-G2	Each Git commit's tree shall be extracted to an empty directory, skipping submodules and refusing entries outside it.	Code <code>GithistoryReader</code>
FR-G3	LLM suggestions shall be one request per commit (temperature 0, JSON output) judged against features already imported; a failure gives a blank suggestion, never an abort, and a suggestion is never committed without the import loop's decision.	Code <code>LlmFeatureSuggestionClient:398-410</code>

Artifact adapter requirements

An adapter reads files of one kind into artifact trees and writes them back. The finer its trees, the more precisely features are traced. Fidelity differs by adapter: line-based adapters are byte-exact, syntax-tree adapters are not.

Contract for every adapter

ID	Requirement	Source
AD-1	An adapter shall be a <code>ArtifactPlugin</code> registered through <code>ServiceLoader</code> , binding its reader, writer and optional viewers through <code>Guice</code> ; <code>getPluginId()</code> returns the plugin class name.	Code; <code>adapter/README.md</code> ; per-adapter plugin-id tests
AD-2	A reader shall return one root node per file carrying <code>PluginArtifactData</code> ; a writer is chosen by that plugin id.	Code DR, DW
AD-3	A reader shall declare prioritized glob patterns; higher priority wins when <code>.adapters</code> is first written, and a tie between enabled adapters is broken by plugin id and logged.	Code; <code>TestDispatchReaderJavaPluginPriorityTest</code> , <code>DispatchReaderPriorityTieTest</code>
AD-4	Adapters shall be enabled or disabled per user; at least one must be enabled.	Code <code>AdapterPreferences</code> , ES
AD-5	Viewers shall not be bound when running headless (<code>ecco.headless</code>).	Code; History 74517278
AD-6	Line-based adapters shall round-trip byte-exact: encoding (UTF-8, else ISO-8859-1), line separator and final newline.	Test <code>TextFileFormatTest</code> (5,000 random rounds)
AD-7	An adapter whose tree format changes shall mark old data with <code>retiredFormat()</code> or a tree-format check, so old repositories are refused for commit, not corrupted.	Code <code>ArtifactData#retiredFormat</code> , <code>JavaASTData.TREE_FORMAT</code> , <code>cpp/data/RetiredFormat</code>
AD-8	An adapter that needs Python shall fail the commit when Python or its modules are missing, not commit an empty file, and shall pick a free py4j port.	Test <code>PythonGatewayPortTest</code> , <code>LilypondGatewayPortTest</code>

Per adapter

Adapter	Files	Granularity	Fidelity required	On by default	Evidence
File	everything else	whole file	byte-exact	yes	<code>FileReaderTest</code> , <code>FileWriterTest</code>
Text	<code>.txt</code> <code>.xml</code> <code>.html</code> <code>.css</code> <code>.js</code> <code>.java</code>	lines	byte-exact	yes	<code>TextReaderTest</code> , <code>TextFileWriterTest</code>
Markdown	<code>.md</code> <code>.markdown</code>	CommonMark/GFM blocks, nested by heading	byte-exact	yes	<code>MarkdownReaderTest</code> , <code>MarkdownFileWriterTest</code>
Image	<code>.png</code> <code>.jpg</code> <code>.jpeg</code> <code>.bmp</code> <code>.gif</code>	pixels	exact colours for PNG/BMP; JPEG lossy; never an empty file	yes	<code>ImageFormatWriteTest</code>

Adapter	Files	Granularity	Fidelity required	On by default	Evidence
Java (AST)	.java	JavaParser AST, Java 18 level	every comment kept; braces, synchronized, arrow cases kept; layout pretty-printed, not byte-exact	yes	JavaASTCommentTest, JavaASTStatementFidelityTest, JavaASTTreeFormatTest
C	.c .h	lines grouped by function; #if as lines; VEVOS traces	byte-exact incl. blank lines, CRLF, Latin-1	yes	CRoundTripTest
C++	.cpp .hpp (+ .c .h when C is off)	lines grouped by namespace, class, enum, function	byte-exact incl. include guards and comments; first format checkout-only	yes	CppRoundTripTest
TypeScript	.ts	statements and blocks (TS compiler in embedded Node.js)	exact text incl. ;, trailing comments, JSDoc; switch/enum order kept	yes	TypeScriptRoundTripTest, TypeScriptOrderTest
Python	.py .ipynb .json	libcst syntax tree; notebook cells; JSON values	not byte-exact: whitespace-only lines normalized, JSON re-indented, notebook outputs ignored	yes	PythonAdapterTest
LilyPond	.ly .ily	tokens (parce)	not byte-exact: tokens rejoined with spaces	yes	LilypondVariantsCommitCheckoutTest
Go	.go	tokens (ANTLR)	exact reconstruction	no	GoWriterTest
Runtime	.runtime .java	Java classes/methods/lines + btrace data	not format-preserving	no	RuntimeWriterTest
Java (lines)	.java	class, imports, members, statements	read-only: checkout refused	no	JavaWriterTest
Challenge	.java	class, method, line + VEVOS traces	read-only: checkout refused	no	ChallengeReader*Test

Interface requirements

Three front ends sit on one service API (EccoService): a CLI for scripting and experiments, a JavaFX GUI for exploration, and a REST server for the external web client. They do not offer the same operations; the matrix at the end shows where they differ.

Command line (cli)

ID	Requirement	Source
IF-C1	The CLI shall offer <code>init</code> , <code>status</code> , <code>adapters</code> , <code>commit -c [-m]</code> , <code>checkout -c</code> , <code>features</code> , <code>traces</code> , <code>get/set</code> , <code>remotes</code> , <code>fork</code> , <code>fetch</code> , <code>pull</code> , <code>push</code> , <code>dg</code> , <code>suggest-constraints</code> and <code>minimize-preview</code> .	Code <code>Main.registerCommands()</code>
IF-C2	<code>commit</code> and <code>checkout</code> shall require a configuration (<code>-c</code>).	Code
IF-C3	Exit codes shall be 0 on success, 1 on a failed command, 2 on invalid arguments; errors go to stderr with their cause chain, the stack trace only with <code>-Decco.debug=true</code> .	Code <code>Main.run</code>
IF-C4	<code>fetch</code> , <code>pull</code> and <code>push</code> shall default to the remote <code>origin</code> ; <code>pull</code> , <code>push</code> and <code>fork</code> take <code>--exclude</code> feature revisions.	Code
IF-C5	<code>suggest-constraints</code> and <code>minimize-preview</code> shall take <code>--min-witness</code> (default 4) and <code>--confidence</code> (default 0.9); only hard (confidence 1.0) accepted constraints are ever applied.	Code
IF-C6	<code>dg</code> shall print the association dependency graph as GML on stdout.	Code
IF-C7	The CLI shall run without JavaFX and bundle the same adapters as the GUI, so it can work on repositories made with the GUI.	Code (<code>ecco.headless</code> , <code>openjfx</code> excluded); Doc
IF-C8	The CLI shall find the repository in the current or nearest parent directory and use that directory as the working directory; <code>init</code> and <code>fork</code> create a repository in the current directory.	Doc; Test <code>MainRepositoryDiscoveryTest</code>

Graphical user interface (gui)

ID	Requirement	Source
IF-G1	The GUI shall group its functions in a ribbon: Repositories (new, open, fork, close), Versions, Collaborate, View, Visualize; repository actions are disabled until a repository is open, and new, open and fork while one is.	Code <code>MainView</code> , <code>RibbonBar</code>
IF-G2	Users shall be able to commit one variant folder or several at once, check out configurations, and manage named variants (add, remove, edit feature revisions, check out several into a base directory).	Code <code>CommitBaseDirView</code> , <code>CommitView</code> , <code>VariantsView</code>
IF-G3	Users shall be able to import a Git history commit by commit, oldest first, with Import, Skip and Stop per reviewed commit, auto-importing the commits between every N-th review (N 1-1000, default 1).	Code <code>ImportGitView</code>
IF-G4	Git import should suggest a configuration per commit from an LLM at any OpenAI-compatible endpoint, configured under Preferences (URL, model).	Code <code>PreferencesView</code> ; Doc
IF-G5	The feature model view shall show the feature model derived from the commits and let users accept, reject or return mined constraints, and minimize presence conditions with them.	Code <code>FeaturesView</code> , <code>ConstraintSuggestionsView</code>
IF-G6	Users shall be able to list and compare commits, list associations with their full and simplified conditions, and browse the artifact tree of any selection of associations, then check out or compose that selection.	Code <code>CommitsView</code> , <code>CommitComparisonView</code> , <code>AssociationsView</code> , <code>ArtifactsView</code>

ID	Requirement	Source
IF-G7	Wherever associations are listed, an association preview shall show their artifacts in their files, coloured by association, for every mapped adapter.	Doc; Code <code>ArtifactDetailView</code> viewers
IF-G8	Checkout results shall show their warnings with a suggested fix; an ambiguous order shall be resolvable by reordering in a dialog and committing.	Code <code>CheckoutDetailView</code> , <code>ReorderChildrenDialog</code>
IF-G9	The GUI shall visualize a knowledge graph (features, commits, variants, associations), the artifact graph and the dependency graph, plus charts, each exportable.	Code <code>view/graph/*</code> , <code>ChartsView</code>
IF-G10	The GUI shall manage remotes, fetch, pull and push, and start a sync server on a chosen port, local-only unless "accept connections from other machines" is set.	Code <code>RemotesView</code> , <code>ServerView</code>
IF-G11	Users shall be able to enable or disable adapters (effective on the next open), and set minimization thresholds and LilyPond paths.	Code <code>PreferencesView</code>

REST server (rest)

ID	Requirement	Source
IF-R1	The REST server shall serve the repositories of a storage directory (<code>ECCO_STORAGE_DIR</code>) to the external ecco-client on port 8081 (<code>PORT</code>), with an OpenAPI description and Swagger UI.	Doc; Code <code>application.yml</code> ; Test <code>SettingsTest</code>
IF-R2	It shall let clients list, create, clone, fork (deselecting features) and delete repositories.	Code <code>RepositoryController</code>
IF-R3	It shall accept a commit as a multipart upload of files, message, configuration and user name.	Code <code>CommitController</code>
IF-R4	It shall let clients describe features and feature revisions, and pull features from another repository while deselecting some.	Code <code>FeatureController</code>
IF-R5	It shall let clients manage variants (add, rename, add/update/remove features) and download a variant's checkout as a file.	Code <code>VariantController</code>
IF-R6	Every endpoint except Swagger shall require an authenticated JWT bearer token.	Code <code>@Secured(IS_AUTHENTICATED)</code>

Where the front ends differ

Operation	CLI	GUI	REST
Commit / checkout	yes	yes	commit upload / variant download
Named variants	no	yes	yes
Fork	yes	yes	yes
Fetch / pull / push	yes	yes	pull only, between its own repositories
Sync server	no	yes	no
Constraint mining	suggest + preview	suggest, accept, minimize	no
Git import	no	yes	no
Visualizations	dg as GML	yes	no

Non-functional requirements

None of these were written as targets; they are recovered from refusals in the code and from fixes that treated a behaviour as a defect. The baselines are measurements recorded with those fixes, not promises.

Reliability and data integrity

ID	Requirement	Source
NFR-R1	A commit shall be atomic: a crash leaves the previous state or the new one, never a mix. Dirty files are staged and rolled forward after the id swap.	Doc; History dc038fdc, 0bc9d570
NFR-R2	Durability shall not rely on per-file fsync; atomicity comes from the roll-forward journal.	History: fsync measured ~10x slower (112 s vs 10.6 s, 21k artifacts) and rejected
NFR-R3	A commit followed by close, reopen and checkout shall reproduce exactly what was committed, for repositories, forks and pulls alike.	Test CommitCheckoutTest; History f9cce6ba, 8a4db407
NFR-R4	Distinct artifacts with equal content shall stay distinct through persistence.	History c288ed2d, da14de14
NFR-R5	Errors shall surface, not be dropped: missing associations throw instead of being skipped; a rollback never follows a successful commit.	History b51026a9
NFR-R6	Write-time pruning of associations shall not be used; it loses data on fork-and-merge.	History (reproduced, closed)

Performance (recorded baselines)

ID	Requirement	Baseline	Source
NFR-P1	Commit and checkout should scale to tens of features and variants interactively.	60 variants / 40 features: commit 1.8 s, checkout 1.1 s, status 0.2 s	History 3b9b5827, 783828fb
NFR-P2	Opening a repository should take seconds, not minutes.	Real x8 repo: 65 s to 5.3 s	History d61968a1
NFR-P3	A commit shall rewrite only what changed.	15.7 s to 2.6 s after skipping identical writes	History 400a3db7
NFR-P4	Pixel-granular images should be usable at around 1.7 megapixels.	71k-px image: commit 67 to 2 s, checkout 157 to 3.4 s	History d6d9006d, 5e4ec81a
NFR-P5	Storage should stay compact as commits accumulate.	Association files 147 to 13 MB (compact counters); packs 2.5-7x smaller	History 783828fb, 69a47552

One performance risk is unbounded: partial-order-graph alignment is factorial in the number of concurrent unresolved branches.

Concurrency

ID	Requirement	Source
NFR-C1	Repository data shall be safe to read and write from background threads while the GUI reads it.	History 2dff68c2, b993d741, 22508fc3, d78d3cb0
NFR-C2	Listener events shall reach every listener even if one throws or events fire from a background thread.	History (CopyOnWriteArrayList, per-listener isolation)
NFR-C3	The GUI shall keep repository writes off the JavaFX thread and UI reads on it.	History ba7aa9b4, f22586c1, b2d960e4

Compatibility and evolution

ID	Requirement	Source
NFR-V1	A repository in an older or retired format shall be refused with an explanation, never fail with an exception or be misread.	Code <code>ArtifactData#retiredFormat</code> , tree-format checks; History 925c956f
NFR-V2	Where an adapter's tree format changed, old repositories should stay checkout-only rather than become unreadable.	History 9639e362 (C++)
NFR-V3	Newer builds shall read older supported formats; older builds need not read newer ones.	Doc; History 783828fb, 69a47552

Security

ID	Requirement	Source
NFR-S1	The sync server shall accept only local connections unless explicitly started on all interfaces.	Doc
NFR-S2	The REST server shall reject upload and repository names that escape their storage folder.	History d6082ea4
NFR-S3	Remote sync is unauthenticated; the GUI shall ask for confirmation before accepting connections from other machines.	Doc; Code <code>ServerView</code> - the missing authentication is a stated limitation
NFR-S4	The REST server shall sign its tokens and refuse unsigned or wrongly signed ones.	Test <code>RestTokenSecurityTest</code> , <code>RestShippedConfigTokenTest</code>
NFR-S5	Outside development mode the REST server shall refuse to start without a JWT secret of at least 32 characters other than the default, and a users file holding password hashes.	Test <code>RestSecurityTest</code>

Platform and build

ID	Requirement	Source
NFR-B1	The system shall build and test with JDK 21+ and the bundled Gradle wrapper, with no other prerequisite.	Doc
NFR-B2	Tests that need optional Python modules (<code>libcst</code> , <code>parce</code>) shall be skipped, not failed, when the modules are absent.	Doc
NFR-B3	CLI and REST shall run headless, without JavaFX on the classpath.	History 74517278
NFR-B4	The GUI shall be installable as a native application on macOS, Linux and Windows.	Doc (jpackage tasks)
NFR-B5	Third-party dependency versions shall be kept in one version catalog.	Doc (<code>gradle/libs.versions.toml</code>)

Known gaps

Requirements the code does not meet, places where the documentation and the code disagree, and partial implementations. Ordered by how likely they are to surprise a user.

#	Gap	Where	Kind
1	The README maps <code>*.c/*.h/*.cpp/*.hpp</code> to the C and C++ adapters by default, but both are disabled by default, so those files go to the File adapter (whole-file granularity, no VEVOS traces) unless enabled in Preferences.	<code>AdapterPreferences.DEFAULT_DISABLED_PLUGIN_IDS</code> vs README	Doc/code mismatch - fixed 2026-10-03 : C and C++ on by default (new repositories only)
2	The CLI only works from the repository root: it fixes the repository at <code>./.ecco</code> , though the README promises a search of parent directories (<code>EccoService.detectRepository</code> exists but is not used).	<code>cli/.../Main.java:41</code> (IF-C8)	Doc/code mismatch - fixed 2026-10-03 : commands search upwards; the repository's directory, not the current one, is the working directory (README corrected)
3	<code>.hashes</code> is written on checkout but never used: the unchanged-file check is commented out, so every commit re-reads every file.	DR:469-476 (FR-M11)	Partial - measured 2026-10-03 , README corrected: reading is 4.5% of a commit for line-based files but 69% for Java AST files (about 1.7 ms per file); the skip is deferred to its own design
4	The <code>java</code> (lines) and <code>challenge</code> adapters have no writer: a checkout of their files writes nothing. Both are off by default.	<code>JavaWriter.java:30</code> in both adapters	Partial - fixed 2026-10-02 : both writers now refuse with a message naming the Java (AST) adapter; documented as read-only
5	Several adapters claim <code>.java</code> (java-ast, java, challenge, runtime) and <code>.c/.h</code> (C, C++) at the same priority; if more than one is enabled, which one wins depends on set order.	adapter patterns	Ambiguous requirement - fixed 2026-10-03 : ties broken by plugin id and logged; C++ yields <code>.c/.h</code> to C
6	Condition minimization is preview-only; it is not applied to checkout.	<code>minimize-preview</code> ; FR-N7	Not implemented - investigated 2026-10-03 : checkout writes files from main-tree node conditions, not from association selection, and persisted minimized conditions are never invalidated by later commits (the GUI can show stale ones). Applying them needs core work; see the gap plan
7	Partial-order-graph alignment is factorial in concurrent unresolved branches; no bound is enforced beyond a capped fallback.	<code>PartialOrderGraph</code>	Performance risk

#	Gap	Where	Kind
8	Remote sync is unauthenticated; the REST server has hard-coded demo users with plaintext passwords and a default JWT secret, and its roles are never checked.	README; <code>rest/.../DummyUserDB</code> , <code>application.yml</code>	Security limitation - hardened 2026-10-03 : the JWT secret key in <code>application.yml</code> was misspelled, so tokens were unsigned and a forged unsigned token was accepted for any user - fixed; the server refuses to start without a real secret and a users file (PBKDF2 hashes) outside development mode; the GUI confirms before syncing with other machines. Still open by choice: sync authentication, role checks
9	The REST storage directory is not configurable; it is chosen by heuristics (Docker, a <code>jenkins</code> user, else <code>examples/</code>).	<code>rest/.../Settings</code>	Missing configuration - fixed 2026-10-03 : <code>ECCO_STORAGE_DIR</code> / <code>ecco.storage-dir</code> , heuristics as fallback, logged at startup
10	Java 21 pattern-matching <code>switch</code> and record patterns are not supported by the Java (AST) adapter and fail loudly; comments inside lambdas and expressions are unverified.	<code>JavaASTReader</code>	Partial
11	Non-lazy composition throws “not yet implemented”.	REPO:831	Not implemented (unused) - fixed 2026-10-02 : the unused option and its branch removed
12	Unknown <code>[<id>]</code> features in a configuration silently create a temporary feature (the strict check is commented out).	<code>ConfigurationParser:160</code>	Weak validation - fixed 2026-10-02 : unknown ids are rejected; fixing it also showed that <code>[<id>]</code> and <code>[<id>].<rev></code> of an <i>existing</i> feature resolved to a new revision instead of the latest or the given one, fixed too
13	A local fork opens its origin read-write (TODO “init read only!”).	ES:756	Partial - resolved 2026-10-03 : a fork only takes shared locks and reads its origin in a read-only transaction; <code>ForkLeavesOriginUnchangedTest</code> shows the origin is left byte-for-byte unchanged, so no read-only mode is needed
14	GUI leftovers: <code>ForkView</code> unused (no Fork in the GUI), <code>FeatureDetailView</code> and <code>PresenceConditionDetailView</code> unreferenced, several <code>ArtifactsView</code> toggles marked TODO.	<code>gui/...</code>	Dead / unfinished UI - fixed 2026-10-03 : Fork is on the Repositories ribbon (rewritten on <code>EccoService.fork</code> , test <code>ForkViewTest</code>); the dead views and placeholder toggles removed
15	<code>lilypond-config.properties</code> contains a hard-coded per-user path.	<code>adapter/lilypond/src/main/resources</code>	Portability - fixed 2026-10-02 : bundled defaults empty, <code>lilypond</code> looked up on the PATH
16	<code>AdapterPreferences.java</code> holds a raw NUL character in a string literal, so git treats the file as binary and hides its diffs.	<code>service/.../AdapterPreferences.java:22</code>	Hygiene - fixed 2026-10-02

#	Gap	Where	Kind
17	The changelog stops at 0.1.9 and no requirements or release notes record the work since; this document is the only consolidated statement of intent.	CHANGELOG.md	Documentation